

Operationalizing Corporate Purpose Through ESG: A TPB Analysis of Consumer Cognition and Purchase Behaviour

Onewo Theophilus Tobi Eshiozemoghie¹ (ORCID ID: 0009-0007-1159-2178)

Zhanna Sergeevna Belyaeva² (ORCID ID: 0000-0002-0876-1803)

ABSTRACT

This paper examines how the theory of planned behaviour (TPB) influence ESG purchases, offering insights into how articulated purpose is validated through consumer markets. The results from the structural equation modelling and surveying 362 Unilever Nigeria customers, show that attitude toward ESG products is the strongest driver of purchase intentions, followed by perceived behavioural control and subjective norms. The study further analyzes the moderating effect of demographic factors on the relationship between these psychosocial determinants and ESG purchasing. By integrating TPB with ESG, this research explains how corporate purpose transitions from statement to stakeholder experience and offers actionable insights for leaders seeking to align corporate purpose with authentic market engagement, thereby enhancing both societal impact and commercial relevance in an era defined by digital transformation and heightened socio-ecological expectations.

Keywords: ESG, corporate purpose, sustainable consumption, theory of planned behaviour, consumer behaviour, environmental attitudes, purchase intention

¹ PhD scholar, Ural Federal University, Russia

² Associate Professor, Ural Federal University, Russia

INTRODUCTION

Nowadays, it is becoming a trend for customers to consider Environmental, Social, and Governance (ESG) factors before making purchase decisions. This is because customers are now becoming more aware of environmental and social issues, and corporate governance failures. This increased awareness and interest has caused a shift from conventional buying behaviour which only considers quality, price, and purchase convenience to sustainable buying behaviour in which consumers patronize brands that align with ESG values and contribute to the realization of sustainable development goals (SDGs; White et al., 2019). This shift has fundamentally reshaped how corporate purpose is defined and being operationalized by corporations. Hence, there are more sustainable products in the market today as most conventionally manufactured products now have sustainable alternatives (Serafeim & Yoon, 2023).

As the demand for sustainable products continues to rise, organizations globally must now balance their profit motive with environmental and social responsibility (Vermeir & Verbeke, 2008). Corporate purpose, the major reason for a company's existence beyond profit maximization (Quinn & Thakor, 2018), is enhanced when ESG initiatives serve as a key mechanism through which companies address customers' sustainability concerns, thereby transforming purpose into action (Gartenberg et al., 2019). Entrenching ESG as part of corporate purpose and culture can be an overwhelming task, especially if all stakeholders do not have a full understanding of the phenomenon (Triviño, 2023). This lack of proper understanding and implementation can have counterproductive consequences like greenwashing, social inequalities, economic disruption, and environmental justice issues, which affect the effectiveness of sustainability initiatives (Malik, 2025).

ESG considerations not only affect customers, but also influence investment decisions, remodel corporate strategies, and change regulatory frameworks (Cappucci, 2018). In the present time, when markets are characterized by consumers who reward purpose-centric companies, organizations that entrench ESG principles into their corporate purpose will enjoy stakeholders' trust, be seen as legitimate, and gain competitive advantage. Research shows that companies with a well-articulated corporate purpose aligned with ESG commitments will excel in financial performance, customer loyalty, and goodwill (Gartenberg et al., 2019).

Nigeria, an emerging economy and one of the largest in Africa, faces significant environmental challenges including pollution, social challenges like poverty and unemployment, and

corporate governance challenges like corruption. Strong ESG performance ensures companies proactively engage in environmental protection, and improve social conditions and corporate governance standards. (Nnadi & Yahaya, 2024). Unilever Nigeria, committed to improving ESG in Nigeria, is a longstanding major player and popular brand in the country's fast moving consumer goods (FMCG) market. Some of the company's ESG efforts include utilizing an internal governance structure to manage sustainability and oversee implementation of ESG strategy. Other specific ESG initiatives include reducing waste, GHG emissions, and water consumption; stakeholder engagement and charity.³ However, despite these diverse efforts, it remains unclear whether they will translate into consumer purchases. Also, there is a need for a deeper understanding of the psychological mechanisms influencing ESG conscious purchases in Nigeria's FMCG industry.

The theory of planned behaviour (TPB) is the foundation of this investigation. This theory, developed by Ajzen in 1991, is among many popular models for comprehending pro-sustainability behaviours. According to the TPB, attitude, subjective norm, and perceived behavioural control (PBC) all predict behavioural intention (Ajzen, 1991). TPB provides insightful information about the intricate processes of choice that go into ESG procurement. TPB has been used as well as expanded upon by numerous studies looking at different facets of sustainability such as alternate modes of transport (Muñoz et al., 2016), rubbish recycling (Echegaray & Hansstein, 2017), water conservation (Lam, 2006), energy conservation (Allen & Marquart-Pyatt, 2018), and low carbon emissions (Jiang et al., 2019). A few studies on green purchase intentions have also validated the model (Han et al., 2009; Barber et al., 2010; Han et al., 2011; Chen & Peng, 2012; Chen & Tung, 2014).

There is disagreement between scholars regarding the relative importance of every determinant of behavioural intention. Furthermore, studies extending the theory to ESG factors are sparse, and to the best of the authors' knowledge, no study has applied the theory to the ESG-behaviour relationship in the context of Nigeria's FMCG sector. Hence, our study examines how TPB constructs influence consumer patronage of ESG-compliant brands with particular attention to the role of demographic factors in the ESG-behaviour relationship. This study contributes to existing literature in several ways: Firstly, it applies TPB to ESG purchasing, an area of research which has received sparse attention. Furthermore, it provides empirical evidence from the Nigerian FMCG sector. The study also highlights important demographic variables that can

³ <https://www.unilever.com/files/92ui5egz/production/a385236bc422513d3c5d65f115177f79728f11a1>

moderate the predictive power of the TPB model in sustainable purchase contexts. Lastly, it offers practical guidance for all stakeholders.

LITERATURE REVIEW AND HYPOTHESIS DEVELOPMENT

ESG Commitments and Value Creation

The operationalization of organizational purpose through ESG commitments represents a strategic redefinition of value creation, positioning purpose at the firm-society interface. Corporate purpose is increasingly enacted through measurable ESG targets that guide ethical leadership and advance inclusive economic development (Henisz, 2023). This integration generates novel frameworks for impact, where value is assessed through a dual lens: financial performance and quantifiable contributions to environmental stewardship, social equity, and transparent governance. Firms that embed authentic ESG commitments into their core strategy create a "purpose premium", building stakeholder trust, enhancing brand resilience, and unlocking markets oriented toward sustainable consumption (Durand & Huynh, 2024). Consequently, the emerging model of value creation extends beyond shareholder returns to encompass systemic health, linking corporate success directly to positive societal and environmental outcomes.

ESG-Conscious Purchases

The ESG framework, encompassing environmental, social, and governance factors, provides consumers with a tangible mechanism to evaluate corporate purpose through purchasing decisions (Kotsantonis et al., 2016). Consumers increasingly seek products and services that align with positive environmental and social impacts, reflecting a market shift where sustainability concerns influence consumption (Carrington et al., 2014). Empirical evidence indicates a growing willingness to pay premium prices for sustainable offerings (Nielsen, 2018), with 73% of global consumers favouring brands that demonstrably reduce environmental impact (Rohde Nielsen, 2023). However, a persistent intention-behaviour gap - known as the *green purchasing paradox* - underscores that stated preferences do not always translate into actual purchases, highlighting the complex interplay between corporate purpose articulation and consumer action (Johnstone & Tan, 2015; Joshi & Rahman, 2015).

Attitude and Purchase Intention

Attitude, defined as an individual's evaluative judgment of a behaviour (Ajzen, 1991), serves as a critical psychological precursor to ESG purchasing. In this context, attitude reflects a consumer's overall evaluation of buying sustainable products, weighing practical benefits against emotional satisfaction. Research demonstrates that positive environmental attitudes correlate strongly with intentions to choose sustainable options, such as recyclable packaging (Barber et al., 2010) or green hotels (Han & Kim, 2010; Chen & Peng, 2012). Nevertheless, conflicting findings in studies on organic products (Zhou et al., 2013; Dean et al., 2012) suggest that attitude alone is insufficient to overcome the intention-behaviour gap. This underscores the need for firms to not only foster favourable attitudes through communication of clear purpose but also to address moderating factors such as subjective norms and perceived behavioural control to effectively translate corporate ESG commitments into consistent consumer behaviour. Therefore, this research proposes that:

H1: Attitude towards ESG products positively influences purchase intention.

Subjective Norms and Purchase Intention

Subjective norms are the perceived social pressures that influence one's behaviour (Ajzen, 1991). They describe a person's belief about whether someone whom they rate highly thinks purchasing ESG products is desirable and whether they should make such purchases. This includes both perceptions of what others think one should do (injunctive norms) and perceptions of what others do (descriptive norms). The moral obligation that consumers face from a variety of interested parties (the public sector, news outlets, famous individuals, charities, health professionals, etc.) to purchase ESG products is conceptualized in the current research as subjective norms.

According to Judge et al. (2019), customers' inclination to buy homes with green certification stickers was favourably impacted by subjective standards. Federal regulations pertaining to green innovation had a strong favourable impact on corporate intention to act (Li et al., 2020). Other investigations concur that purchase intentions in various sustainability environments are determined by subjective norms, including the intention to purchase organic food (Ha & Janda, 2012; Dean et al., 2012), environmentally conscious consumption (Khare, 2015; Tsarenko et al., 2013; Moser, 2015), and green hotel patronage (Teng et al, 2014; Han et al., 2010; Chen & Tung, 2014).

Therefore, this study proposes that:

H2: Subjective norms positively influence ESG purchase intention

Perceived Behavioural Control and Purchase Intention

Perceived behavioural control (PBC) is an individual's perception of the ease or difficulty involved in performing a specific behaviour based on their past experience, capabilities and resources (Ajzen, 1991). In ESG purchasing contexts, such factors include product affordability, availability, and consumer confidence in identifying genuinely sustainable products.

In a variety of sustainability research settings, such as conservation (Albayrak & Caber, 2013), green hotels (Teng et al., 2014; Han et al., 2010; Chen & Tung, 2014; Chang et al., 2014), and green products (Moser, 2015), many research investigations have demonstrated a favourable association across PBC and behaviour. Considering the aforementioned, we suggest that:

H3: PBC has significant positive impact on ESG purchase intention

ESG Purchase Intention and ESG Purchase Behaviour

The likelihood of carrying out a behaviour is positively correlated with behavioural intention, which serves as a driving force behind embracing that action. The degree to which customers intend to actively participate in ESG buying behaviour is referred to in current research as ESG behavioural intention. TPB was used by Yu et al. (2020) to explore the ways in which farmers' attitudes, subjective norms, as well as perceived control over behaviours affect both their intention and actual engagement in environmental, social, and governance behaviour. Thus, this research suggests that:

H4: ESG purchase intention positively influences actual ESG purchase behaviour

Demographic Influences on ESG Purchase Behaviour

Beyond the core TPB constructs, the following demographic characteristics have been identified as important moderating variables in ESG purchase decisions:

- i. *Age*: Age is a critical factor that influences sustainable purchasing behaviour (Kardos et al., 2019). It has been noted that younger consumers (millennials and Generation Z) show higher levels of environmental consciousness and willingness to pay premiums for sustainable products. This is because they grew up in decades marked by increased

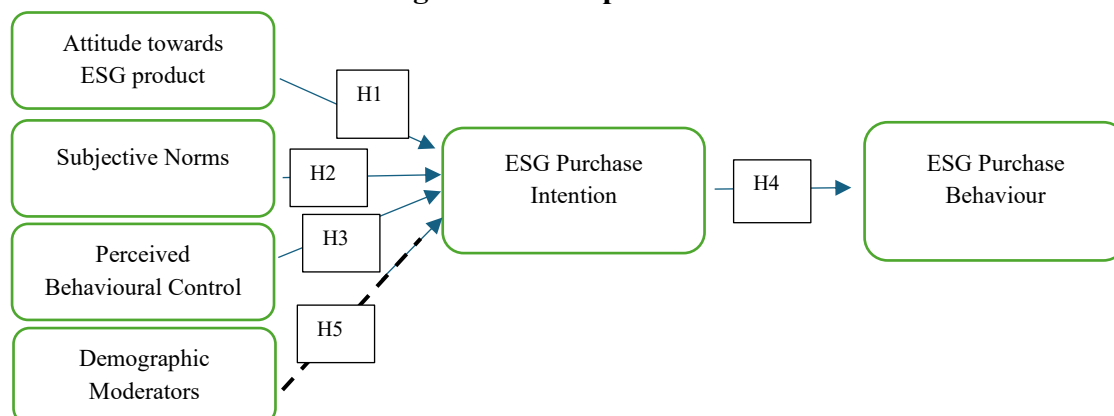
environmental awareness and have easier access to sustainability information through digital platforms (White et al., 2019). Nevertheless, older consumers may have greater financial resources to support premium pricing for ESG products (Nielsen, 2018).

- ii. *Income*: Income can affect consumers' ability to afford higher-priced ESG products. It has been observed that consumers who earn high income have more willingness and ability to pay for sustainable products, while consumers who earn lower income may favour products with lower prices than products with sustainability attributes (Carrington et al., 2014).
- iii. *Education*: Consumers' education levels influence their awareness and consciousness of ESG issues, which eventually affect their ESG purchase intention and behaviour. Highly educated people exhibit high awareness of corporate social responsibility issues, possess considerable environmental knowledge, and exhibit positive attitudes toward sustainable products. This is opposite for individuals with lower levels of education (Nguyen et al., 2023).
- iv. *Gender*: Differences exist in ESG purchasing intention behaviour across genders. Women frequently show more awareness and consciousness on sustainability issues. Hence, they exhibit more positive attitudes toward sustainable products and engage more in pro-sustainable behaviours compared to their male counterparts (Brough et al., 2016).

Therefore, the study proposes that:

H5: Demographic variables significantly moderate the relationship between TPB constructs and ESG purchase intention.

Figure 1: Conceptual Framework



Source: Authors' own

The conceptual framework shown in Figure 1 illustrates the factors influencing ESG purchase intention, and subsequently, ESG purchase behaviour, and the moderating role of demographic variables in shaping these influences.

Review of Related Literatures and Gap

Previous research has successfully applied TPB to various pro-environmental behaviours. Li et al. (2023) examined the ways in which elements of the theory of planned behaviour affect the green development behaviour of construction companies. The data for the study consisted of responses from 306 building service providers in 28 Chinese provinces. Partial least squares structural equation modelling (PLS-SEM) was used to analyze the data. Researchers found that mindsets, subjective standards, and behavioural control have a substantial impact on construction companies' willingness to adopt environmentally conscious building practices. It was discovered that attitude is the best indicator of purpose.

Han et al. (2023) extended the theory of planned behaviour to analyze consumers' intention to purchase meal kits. The contributing factor was how consumers viewed businesses' ESG management. Data was collected from 324 customers who were 20 years of age or older. The desire to buy was significantly positively impacted by all TPB constructs. The intention to buy was also positively impacted by price sensitivity and belief in the sustainability of the bundle. Purchase intention was also moderated by people's assessments of businesses' ESG management strategies.

Filho et al. (2024) investigated the interaction between the intrinsic and extrinsic factors influencing sustainable behaviours in the circular economy by applying the theory of planned behaviour and the value-belief-norm theory. Data for the study were drawn from a Brazilian sample, and a composite-based structural equation model (cSEM) was used to test the hypotheses. According to the report, perceptions of sustainable behaviours were considerably improved by greater knowledge about the concept of the circular economy. Moreover, internal factors, values, and favourable assessments of sustainability outcomes have a greater impact on sustainable behaviour than outside variables such as environmental regulations and corporate guidelines.

The TPB paradigm was extended by Pirani and Patil (2024) to include concerns regarding environment and social responsibility in their assessment of the variables influencing the behavioural intention of sustainable investments. A total of 425 individual responses were

collected, which were then analyzed using structural equation modelling (SEM). The results show that intentions towards sustainable investments were significantly and positively impacted by attitude, subjective standards, environmental concerns, and social responsibility. Dreifert and Rigotti (2025) utilized TPB as a rational-cognitive model in order to comprehend how opinions influence intents and behaviours related to the social aspect of ESG. Data for this study were collected from 337 workers in Germany and the UK. The findings from the study clarify how TPB structures affect socially conscious motives and, above all, actions. Attitude was determined to be the strongest predictor of the social components of ESG. Using the TPB framework, Lucarelli et al. (2020) examined the moderating influence of COVID-19 beliefs on pro-environmental behaviour. The same group of learners were given questions both before and after the COVID-19 pandemic. Partial least squares structural equation modelling (PLS-SEM) was used to analyze the data generated. The results indicate that the relationships between TPB constructs and pro-environmental behaviour were not weakened by the COVID-19 pandemic. Additionally, individuals who were conscious of the connection between the COVID-19 pandemic and climate change showed stronger pro-environmental intentions and behaviours.

Le and Quynh (2025) investigated the behavioural intentions of Gen Zs in support of carbon neutrality in Vietnam's transportation sector. The TPB-based study looked at the connection between Gen Z's aspirations for carbon offsetting and TPB constructions, including trust as an extra variable. Data for this study were collected from 300 Gen Z customers in Ho Chi Minh City, and analyzed using PLS-SEM. The study concluded that behavioural intention is influenced by attitudes, subjective standards, and perceived behavioural control. Paul et al. (2016) used TPB to predict Indian customers' intentions to make green purchases. This study collected data from 521 participants. The findings indicate that while subjective norms have no discernible influence on purchase intention, both customer attitude and PBC do. Additionally, the results assert that TPB controls the relationship between green buying intention and environmental concern.

Thwe et al. (2025) used TPB to examine why people choose to buy electric cars. The study also looked at the function of moral standards. A survey yielded 472 responses, which were analyzed using PLS-SEM. The results show that consumers' intentions to buy electric cars were influenced primarily by their attitudes, followed by PBC, moral standards, and personal norms. García-Salirrosas et al. (2024) investigated how attitude and PBC are affected by environmental awareness. This study also assessed how TPB constructs influenced the

willingness of Peruvian consumers between the ages of 18 and 30 to pay for eco-friendly goods. The sample for this study consisted of 405 consumers whose responses were analysed using PLS-SEM. The findings demonstrate that attitude and PBC were significantly improved by environmental awareness. Additionally, intention to pay was significantly and positively influenced by the three TPB components.

Previous research applied TPB primarily to examine pro-environmental behaviours and social dimensions of ESG. However, to the best of the authors' knowledge, no study has applied TPB to examine ESG purchase intention, and subsequently, behaviour. Furthermore, none of the reviewed studies have focused on the Nigerian FMCG context. This is a crucial gap as ESG purchasing is different from conventional green consumption in many ways. Because ESG considerations extend beyond environmental factors to include social and governance dimensions, consumer decision-making processes are likely to become more complicated (Townsend, 2020; Reber et al., 2022). Furthermore, ESG products mostly involve complex corporate practices and supply chains which are less visible to consumers than conventional environmental attributes (Lyon & Maxwell, 2011). Hence, to fill this gap, our study uses TPB to study ESG purchase behaviour in the Nigerian FMCG context while also addressing the moderating role of demographic variables.

METHODOLOGY

This investigation uses a quantitative research approach. The target population for this study comprises of customers of Unilever Plc. in Nigeria's fast moving consumer goods sector. The sample for this study was selected using stratified random and purposive sampling techniques. The use of stratified random sampling ensured proportional representation of key demographic variables such as age, gender, income level, and education while the use of purposive sampling ensured that only those knowledgeable about ESG issues were included in the sample. Primary data were collected using an online questionnaire with a five-point Likert scale. All constructs were measured using established scales from previous research (Lucarelli et al., 2020; Le & Quynh, 2025; Paul et al., 2016) adapted for the ESG purchasing context. The measurement model demonstrated good fit to the data ($\chi^2 = 234.56$, $df = 142$, $p < .001$; CFI = .95; TLI = .94; RMSEA = .037; SRMR = .041) according to established criteria (Byrne, 2016). All factor loadings exceeded .70, and Cronbach's α ranged from .84 to .92, indicating acceptable internal consistency. A total of 362 questionnaire responses were deemed valid and useful for the analysis. The hypotheses were tested through structural equation modelling.

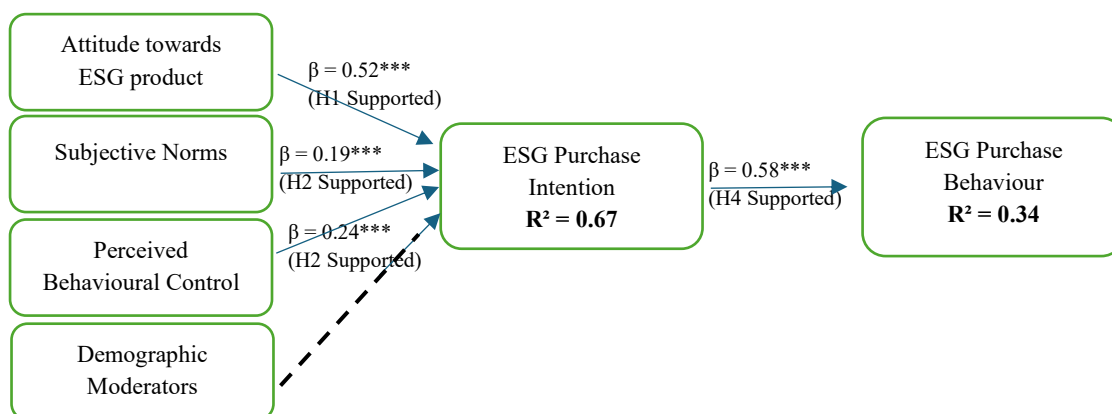
Table 1: Respondents' Demographic Profile (N = 362)

SN	Questionnaire Items	Scale	Frequency	Percentage (%)
1	AGE	18- 25	108	29.8%
		26–35	124	34.3%
		36–45	72	19.9%
		45 and above	58	16.0%
2	GENDER	Male	154	42.5%
		Female	208	57.5%
3	MONTHLY INCOME	Less than ₦50,000	91	25.1%
		₦50,000– ₦100,000	157	43.4%
		Above ₦100,000	114	31.5%
4	EDUCATIONAL QUALIFICATION	High School	63	17.4%
		Bachelor's / H.N. D	181	50.0%
		Postgraduate	118	32.6%

Source: Authors' own

Table 1 above shows that most of the respondents (64.1%) belonged to the younger generations which implies that they are more aware about ESG issues. Furthermore, most of the respondents (57.5%) were women. The table also shows that most of the respondents were highly educated and had good monthly income.

Figure 2: Structural Model Results with Path Coefficients



Source: Structural Equation Model

Figure 2 above shows the structural equation model. The model demonstrated substantial explanatory power, explaining 67% of the variance in purchase intention and 34% of the

variance in purchase behaviour. The R^2 value of 0.67 implies that the finding is significant. It indicates that while a significant proportion of green ESG purchase intention is accounted for by the chosen TPB predictors, the remaining 33% captures additional variables not captured in this model. The R^2 value of 0.34 indicates moderate explanatory power for the structural model. The results validate the theoretical framework used and justify the inclusion of the selected antecedents in predicting ESG purchase behaviour. Future research may consider integrating additional constructs to improve predictive capability, but the current model is both statistically and theoretically sound for the purposes of this study (Hair et al., 2021).

Table 2: Structural Model Results and Hypotheses Testing

Hypotheses	Path	Std. Coefficient (β)	t-value	p-value	Result
H1	Attitude $\rightarrow$ Purchase Intention	0.52	8.34	< .001	Supported
H2	Subjective Norms $\rightarrow$ Purchase Intention	0.19	3.12	< .01	Supported
H3	Perceived Control $\rightarrow$ Purchase Intention	0.24	4.18	< .001	Supported
H4	Purchase Intention $\rightarrow$ Purchase Behaviour	0.58	10.67	< .001	Supported

Source: Structural Equation Model

Table 2 shows that all TPB constructs significantly predict ESG purchase intention, which in turn significantly predicts ESG purchase behaviour. Hence, H1-H4 were accepted. Of all the constructs, attitude was the strongest predictor of ESG purchase intention, followed by PBC, whereas subjective norms was the least significant. This aligns with the findings of Thwe et al. (2025) and Chan et al. (2022).

Table 3: Demographic Moderation Analysis Results

Moderator	Moderated Path	Low Group	High Group	$\Delta\chi^2$	p-value	Result
Age	Attitude $\rightarrow$ Purchase Intention	$\beta = 0.61$ (Young)	$\beta = 0.38$ (Old)	15.23	< .001	Supported
	Subjective Norms $\rightarrow$ Purchase Intention	$\beta = 0.24$ (Young)	$\beta = 0.12$ (Old)	8.94	< .01	Significant
	PBC $\rightarrow$ Purchase Intention	$\beta = 0.26$ (Young)	$\beta = 0.22$ (Old)	3.21	.073	Not Significant

Income	Attitude → Purchase Intention	$\beta = 0.48$ (Low)	$\beta = 0.55$ (High)	2.87	.090	Not Significant
	Subjective Norms → Purchase Intention	$\beta = 0.16$ (Low)	$\beta = 0.22$ (High)	4.12	< .05	Significant
	PBC → Purchase Intention	$\beta = 0.18$ (Low)	$\beta = 0.31$ (High)	11.76	< .001	Supported
Education	Attitude → Purchase Intention	$\beta = 0.45$ (Low)	$\beta = 0.58$ (High)	9.34	< .01	Supported
	Subjective Norms → Purchase Intention	$\beta = 0.21$ (Low)	$\beta = 0.17$ (High)	1.89	.169	Not Significant
	PBC → Purchase Intention	$\beta = 0.22$ (Low)	$\beta = 0.26$ (High)	2.14	.144	Not Significant
Gender	Attitude → Purchase Intention	$\beta = 0.45$ (Male)	$\beta = 0.58$ (Female)	7.83	< .01	Supported
	Subjective Norms → Purchase Intention	$\beta = 0.14$ (Male)	$\beta = 0.24$ (Female)	6.21	< .05	Supported
	PBC → Purchase Intention	$\beta = 0.27$ (Male)	$\beta = 0.21$ (Female)	2.94	.086	Not Significant

Source: Structural Equation Model

The result of the multigroup analysis in Table 3 above demonstrates that demographic characteristics significantly moderate the relationship between the TPB constructs and ESG purchase intentions. Specifically, age moderates the relationships between TPB constructs and ESG purchase intention, with younger customers showing higher beta coefficient values than older customers. Similarly, income moderates the TPB-ESG purchase intention relationships as customers with higher incomes showed higher beta coefficient values than those with lower incomes. Education also significantly moderates the relationships between the TPB constructs and ESG purchase intention as customers with higher levels of education showed higher beta coefficient values than those with lower education levels. Lastly, gender significantly moderates the TPB-ESG purchase intention relationships as female customers showed higher beta coefficient values than male customers.

CONCLUSION

This study extends the applicability of the theory of planned behaviour to the ESG purchasing context, with all TPB constructs significantly predicting intention. The high variance in purchase intention (67%) demonstrates that ESG influenced purchasing is enhanced by psychological processes. Hence, TPB is a strong framework for explaining sustainable consumption decisions (Armitage & Conner, 2001). This finding is critical for corporate purpose strategists, as it provides a concrete foundation upon which corporations can build authentic purpose-driven strategies (Gartenberg et al., 2019)

The finding that attitude is the strongest predictor of ESG purchase intention suggests that cognitive evaluations of ESG products play a crucial role in consumer decision-making. Therefore, companies whose purpose excludes visible ESG commitments risk undermining attitude - the primary driver of purchase intentions. This finding has important implications for understanding how consumers process complex sustainability information and form overall judgments about ESG products (Luchs & Kumar, 2017).

The findings about the moderation effects of demographic variables provide new insights into the boundary conditions of TPB in sustainable consumption contexts. The stronger effects observed among younger, more educated, higher-income, and female consumers suggest that TPB relationships are not the same across consumer segments. Hence, organizations must understand the heterogeneous nature of the market and adapt their ESG communication and implementation accordingly.

The study recommends that organizations should invest more in ESG awareness, thereby building positive attitudes toward ESG products. Information about the advantages of ESG purchasing should be credible and clear in order to enhance informed decision-making across all consumer groups. Businesses should develop targeted product lines and communication strategies tailored to the demographic segments that show stronger TPB relationships and consider pricing strategies that acknowledge price sensitivity and financial capacity differences. Lastly, policymakers should support initiatives that ensure the availability and affordability of ESG products.

Practical Implications for Corporate Purpose Advancement

The findings offer actionable insights for corporations seeking to advance their corporate purpose. They establish that consumer ESG purchasing is influenced by systematic psychological (TPB) factors. Therefore, corporate purpose strategists must seek to understand these psychological mechanisms to build appropriate purpose-driven strategies. Companies should not stop at purpose statements alone but should validate such statements with evident ESG commitments and actions that create shared value for stakeholders.

Furthermore, since ESG corporate purpose resonates differently with customer segments, organizations should develop a deeper understanding of the heterogeneity of their stakeholders and tailor their corporate purpose communication, ESG commitments, and implementation strategies accordingly. Organizations should also pursue active stakeholder engagement and gather feedback from consumers to validate, reinforce, and advance corporate purpose commitments.

Note: All research procedures were conducted in accordance with the approved ethical guidelines.

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